



California Voter Views of CEQA Exemptions for Advanced Manufacturing

Key Findings of a Survey Conducted March 5-11, 2026



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& ASSOCIATES

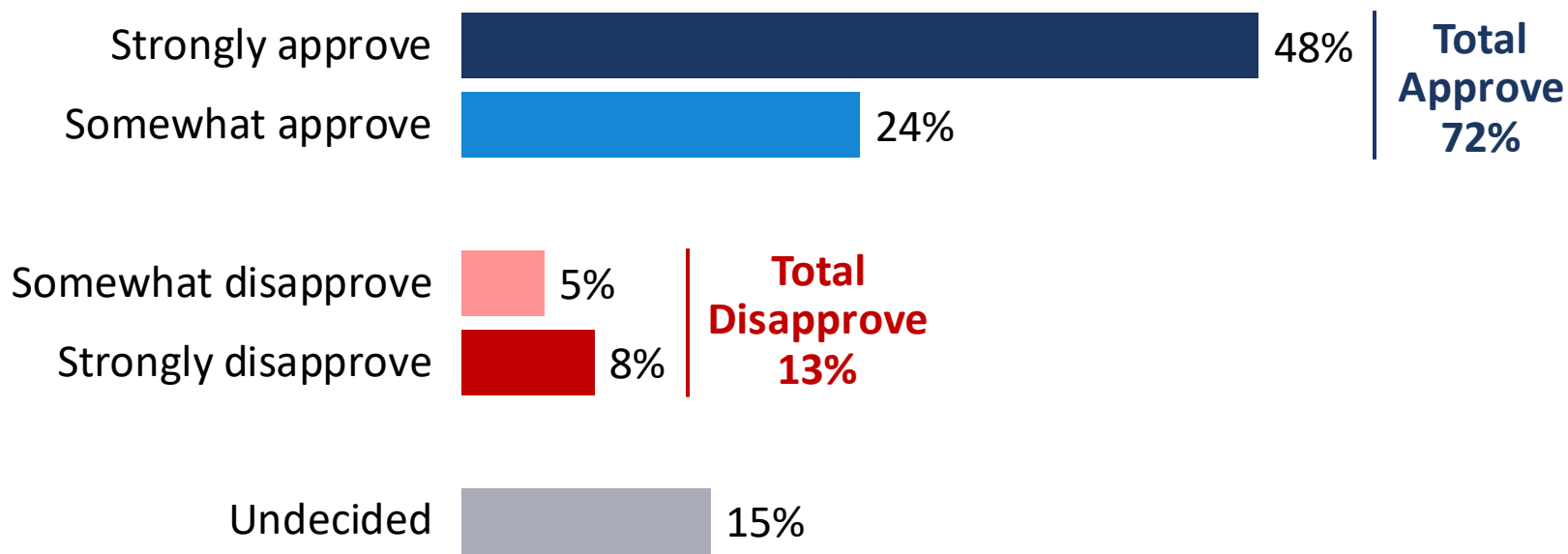
Survey Methodology

Dates	March 5-11, 2026
Survey Type	Dual-mode Voter Survey
Research Population	Likely November 2026 Voters in California
Total Interviews	600
Margin of Sampling Error	(Full Sample) $\pm 4.0\%$ at the 95% Confidence Level (Half Sample) $\pm 5.7\%$ at the 95% Confidence Level
Contact Methods	 Telephone Calls  Text Invitations
Data Collection Modes	 Telephone Interviews  Online Interviews

(Note: Not All Results Will Sum to 100% Due to Rounding)

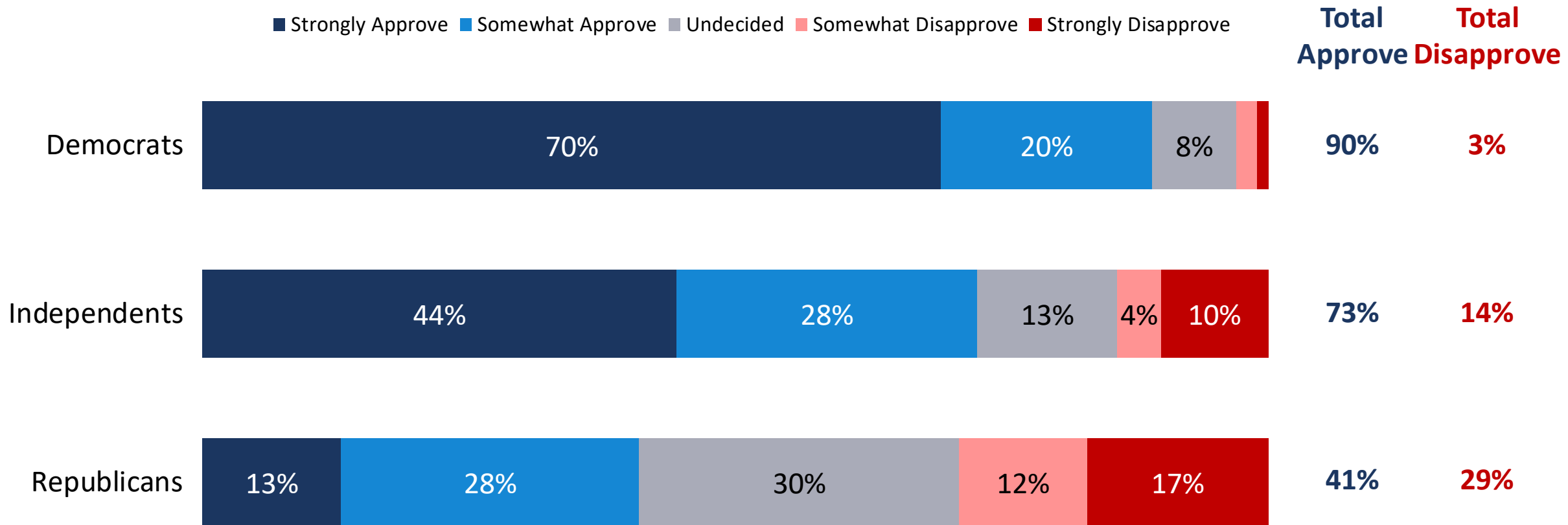
Seven in ten California voters approve of CEQA as described, and nearly half “strongly approve” of the law.

California enacted the California Environmental Quality Act, or CEQA, in 1970 with bipartisan support. The law requires public agencies to evaluate the public health and environmental impacts of proposed advanced manufacturing and other development projects before approval. Agencies must identify and disclose to the public potential harms the projects can cause to air and water quality and consider ways to reduce those harms. In general, do you approve or disapprove of this law?



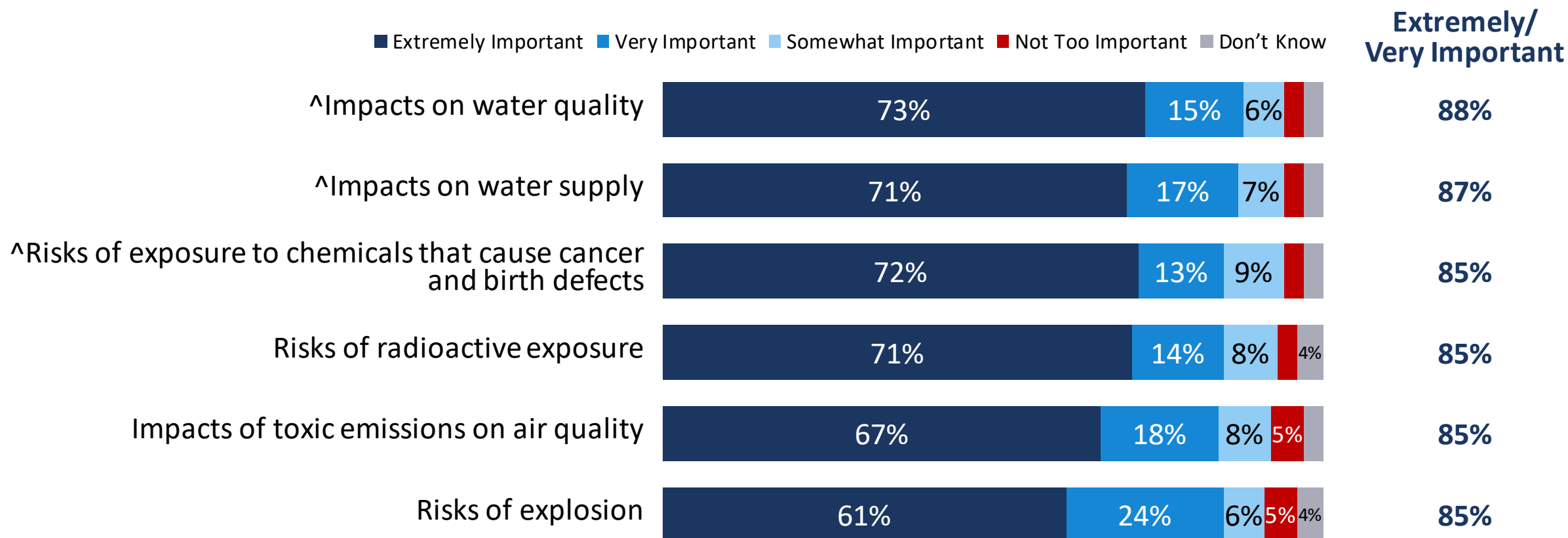
Opinions break along party lines, with nine in ten Democrats approving of CEQA.

Approval of CEQA By Party



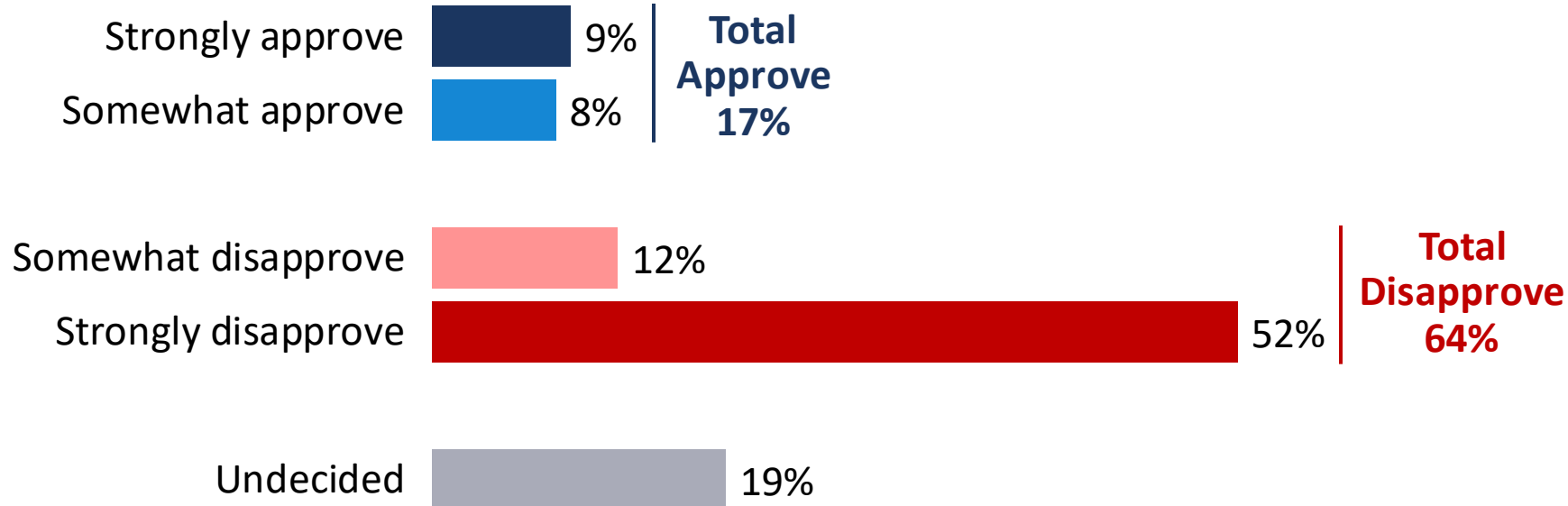
Voters believe it is highly important to study new development for impacts on water quality and supply.

Next, please consider a list of potential impacts that CEQA requires to be studied for new development projects in California. For each one, please indicate whether it is extremely important, very important, somewhat important, or not too important to continue to study, disclose and reduce these impacts.



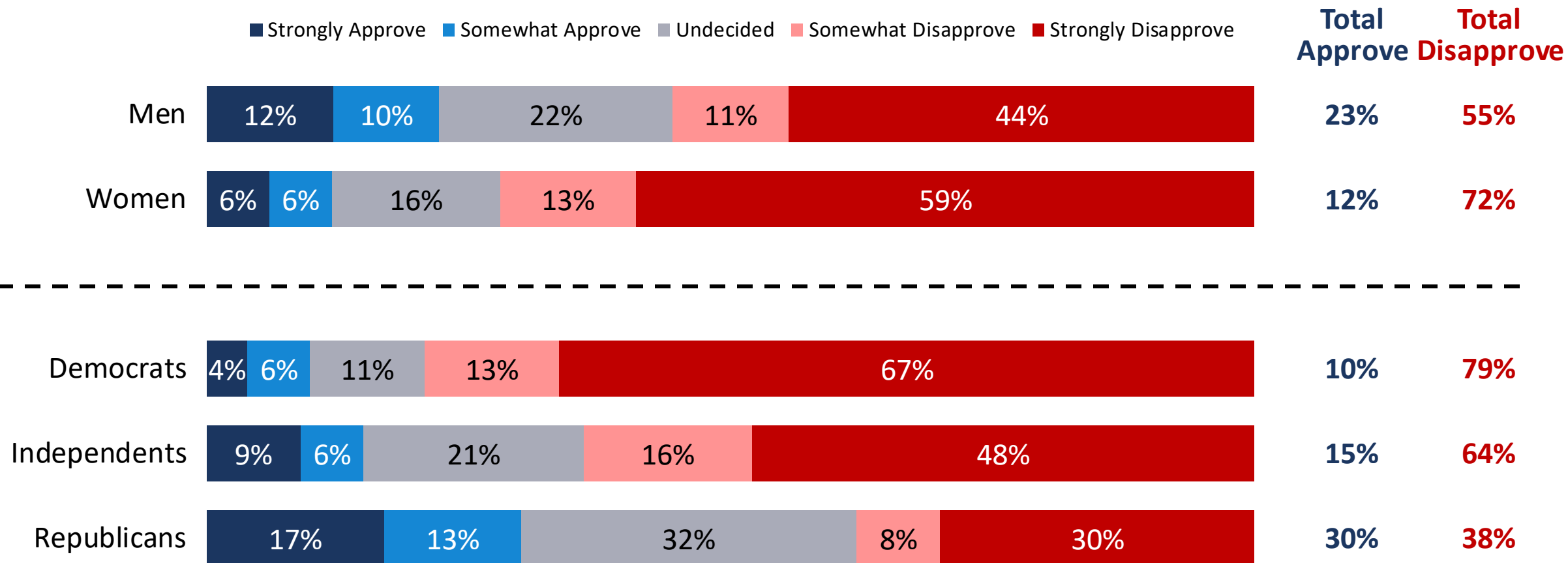
Nearly two-thirds of voters disapprove of exempting advanced manufacturing from CEQA review and disclosure.

Next, last year the State Legislature voted to give advanced manufacturing projects a special exemption from the California Environmental Quality Act's public health and environmental impact review and public disclosure requirements. "Advanced manufacturing" is a broad term that includes more than 60 types of industrial facilities and processes, including strip mining, plastic and metal fabrication, pesticide manufacturing, waste incineration, defense and aerospace manufacturing, silicon chip manufacturing and other types of manufacturing facilities. This means that from now on, new proposed projects in these categories can be built with no review or disclosure of their impacts on public health or California's environment under the California Environmental Quality Act.



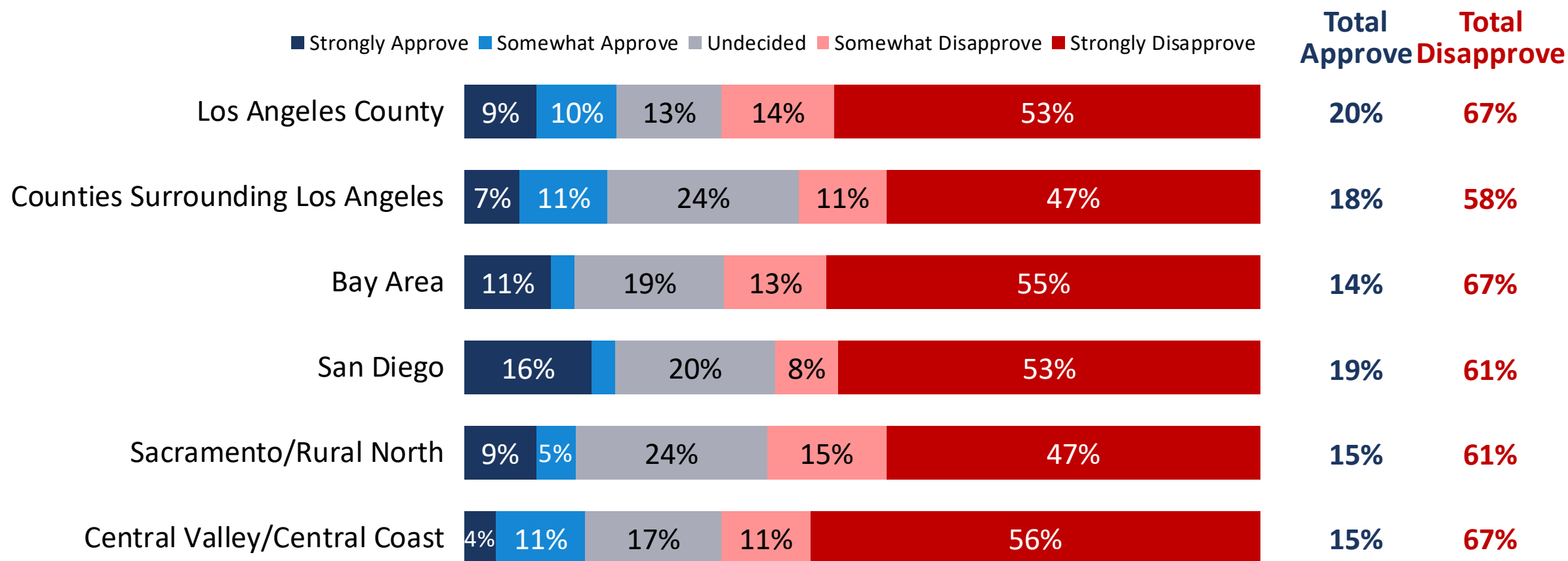
Four in five Democrats, nearly two-thirds of independents and a plurality of GOP voters disapprove of the exemption.

Initial Opinion by Gender & Party



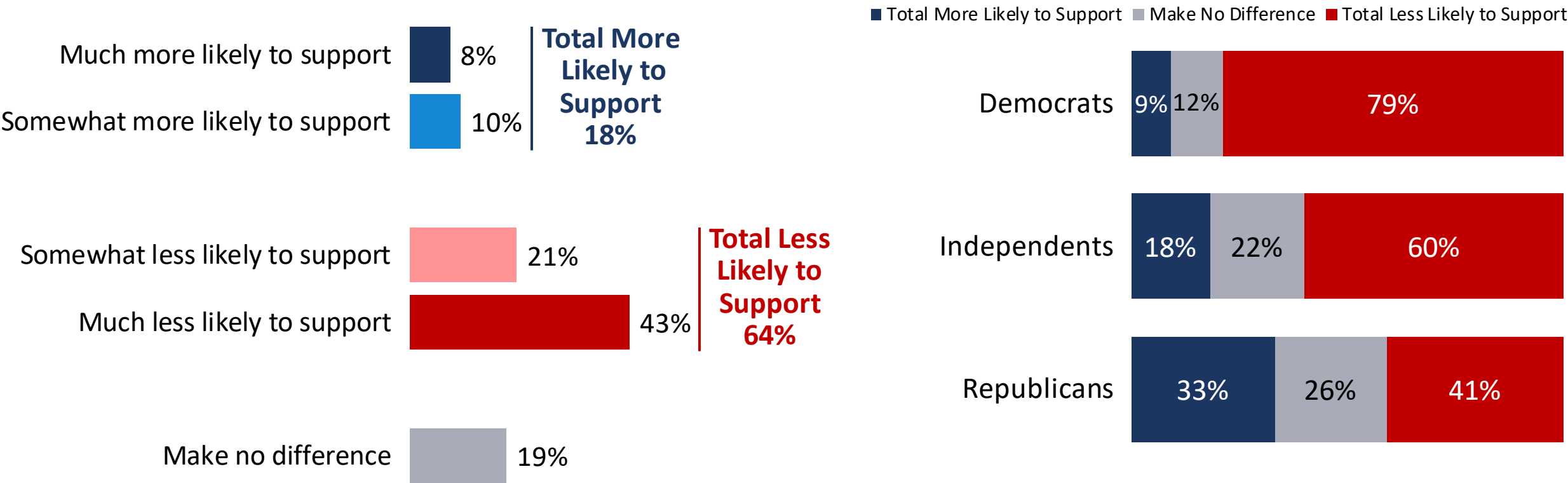
Broad shares object to the exemption across every region of the state.

Initial Opinion by Region



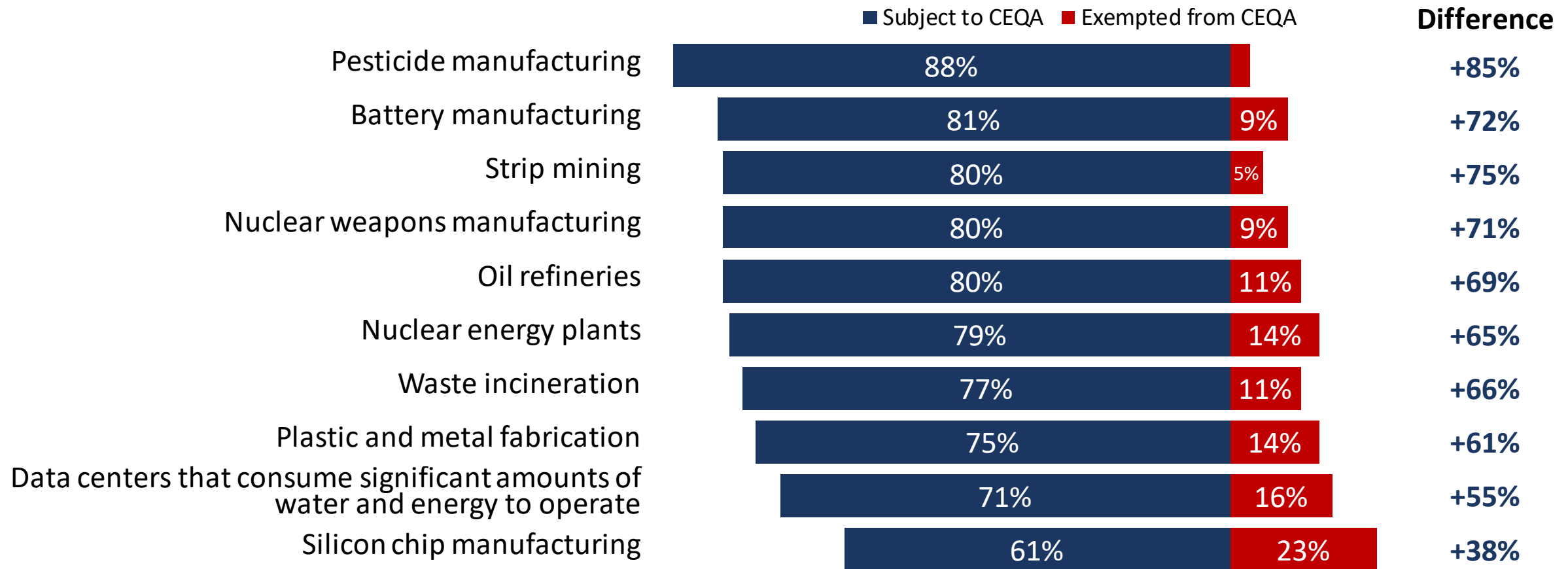
More than three in five say they would be less likely to support a legislator who backed the CEQA exemption.

If your State Legislator supported exempting advanced manufacturing from environmental review and disclosure under CEQA, would that make you more likely to support your State Legislator, less likely to support them, or would it make no difference to you?



Voters overwhelmingly believe that a range of specific types of advanced manufacturing should be subject to CEQA.

Next, here is a list of types of advanced manufacturing businesses. Please indicate whether you believe each one should be subject to environmental and public health review and disclosure under the California Environmental Quality Act, or they should be exempt from it.





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